

Cityhenges

A sight to be seen

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Have you ever heard of the “Manhattanhenge”? Well, if you have, you know you are in for a treat. If not, then the term was coined in reference to an annual geographical phenomenon where the sun aligns with the buildings of the city of Manhattan, creating a Stonehenge like scene. Ever since it was first observed by Neil deGrasse Tyson, people come to Manhattan on the days of summer and winter solstice to click pictures and witness this phenomenal scene.

After Manhattanhenge became popular in the science and geek circles, its direct correlation with the winter and summer solstice has led to people around the world having marked out similar spots. These are within cities and observe this phenomenon once or twice a year, depending on their alignment with the Sun. The generalised term that is used to describe this phenomenon now is cityhenges. And, in this article, we will have a look at some city henges across the globe. Who knows, you might want to go there the next time it happens?



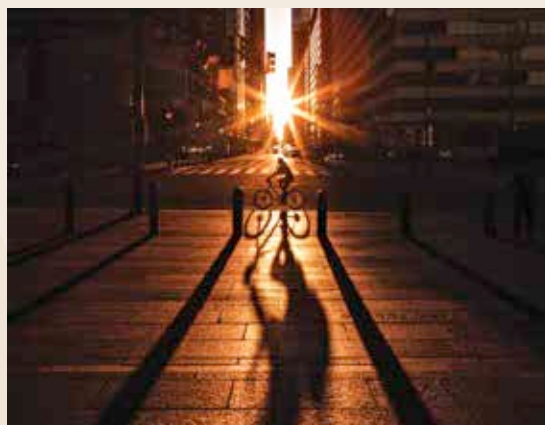
Manhattanhenge

There's not much to describe here. The Manhattanhenge over the years has come to be a globally popular phenomenon, with photographers and geeks flocking to the city in June and December/January every year to click pictures and observe it! However, the rise in popularity of this phenomenon has led to the city's traffic flow and pedestrian safety taking a big hit year on year.



Chicagohenge

Every year in Chicago, on September 25 and March 20, the Sun lines up with the city's grid, and the day in some circles is known as Chicagohenge Day! Don't book your tickets though, as there are some changes to the day owing to several factors, and observers keep a keen eye on the calendar to mark the day every year!



Phillyhenge

Another US city to make it to this list is Philadelphia. With its grid alignment being 9 degrees off North, the Henge day (yes, we are calling it that) falls close to the equinoxes. However, it is only around September 5 every year that people are able to observe the henge because the weather on the other equinox day tends to cast a shadow on an otherwise great sight!